HSE Field Guide | SERNEM Pro Series | Site validation required

SERNEM Health and Safety Resources

WORKING AT HEIGHT CRITICAL SAFETY RULES

Plan • Prioritize Collective Protection • Prevent Falls

OSHA 1926.501(b)(1) / .502(d)(15)
OSHA · US construction · Verify local requirements separately

Document · EN
SRN-WAH-001
Revision 2.0
Content updated
2026-10-26

Scan: open the digital poster library

SERNEM · Check Before Starting

Pre-Job Check

- ✓ Work permit
- ✓ Risk assessment
- ✓ Collective protection
- ✓ Approved anchorage
- ✓ Fall clearance
- ✓ Rescue plan
- ✓ Weather and drop zone

01 REQUIRED — Pre-Work Planning

- ✓ Verify the risk assessment and work permit.
- ✓ Define the safe access and work method.
- ✓ Barricade the area below and prevent unauthorized access.

02 REQUIRED — Use Collective Protection

- ✓ Prioritize collective protection using guardrails, platforms or suitable scaffolds; protect openings.
- ✓ OSHA construction: unprotected edges at ≥6 ft (1.8 m) require guardrails, safety nets or personal fall arrest.
- ✓ This threshold is not universal: scaffolds and ladders have separate rules. Lower heights are not automatically safe.

03 REQUIRED IF — Full Body Harness

Applies when: Personal fall protection is used

- ✓ Inspect webbing, stitching and labels before every use.
- ✓ Wear, fasten and adjust the harness correctly.
- ✓ Remove damaged or fall-arrested equipment from service.

04 REQUIRED IF — Approved Anchorage

Applies when: Personal fall arrest is used

- ✓ Personal fall-arrest anchorages must be independent of anchorages supporting or suspending platforms.
- ✓ OSHA: at least 5,000 lb (22.2 kN) per attached employee; OR the alternative design below.
- ✓ Alternative: a complete system with a safety factor of at least 2, designed, installed and used under a qualified person’s supervision.

05 REQUIRED IF — Fall Clearance

Applies when: A fall-arrest system is used

- ✓ Calculate free-fall and total clearance distance.
- ✓ Prevent contact with lower levels or obstructions.
- ✓ Minimize the risk of a swing fall.

06 REQUIRED — Safe Access

- ✓ Use inspected access equipment suitable for the task.
- ✓ Maintain three-point contact on ladders.
- ✓ Keep access routes clear, stable and unobstructed.

07 REQUIRED IF — Prevent Dropped Objects

Applies when: There is a falling-object hazard

- ✓ Secure tools using a suitable tethering system.
- ✓ Store materials safely away from edges.
- ✓ Isolate the area below and control access.

08 REQUIRED IF — Rescue Readiness

Applies when: Personal fall protection or rescue hazards apply

- ✓ Prepare a workable rescue plan before starting.
- ✓ Ensure rescue equipment and trained personnel are available.
- ✓ Verify emergency communication and response arrangements.

Stop Work Now

- **Required fall protection or an approved anchorage for the selected system is unavailable**
- **The harness, lanyard or connector is damaged**
- **An unprotected edge or open hole is present**
- **No rescue plan or response capability is available**
- **Wind, ice or visibility conditions are unsafe**

Critical Controls

COLLECTIVE
Guardrails and platforms first

5,000 lb
22.2 kN per employee OR complete system with factor ≥2 under qualified supervision

CLEARANCE
Prevent lower-level contact

RESCUE
Prepare before work

Technical Reference · Validation Required
OSHA 1926.501(b)(1) / .502(d)(15)
Verify source scope and local requirements

Risk-Based PPE Selection

- **Chin-Strap Helmet** — Head and chin-strap fit
- **Safety Glasses** — Eye particle hazard
- **Work Gloves** — Grip and mechanical risk
- **Slip-Resistant Footwear** — Slip-resistant sole
- **Full Body Harness** — Compatible fall system

Select PPE by risk, manufacturer and site procedure; this list is not mandatory for every task.

SERNEM
Better Safety, Better Tomorrow.

Stop Work If It Is Unsafe!

Verify site procedure
www.sernem.com

REQUIRED: work control · REQUIRED IF: binding when applicable · WARNING: hazard alert. Verify legal applicability separately.